

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Hospitality and Tourism English

Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

02 Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

03 Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

04 Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

06 Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

07 Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

check-in - The process of registering an arrival; also a short meeting to review progress.

room inventory - The rooms available for sale or assignment under the property's current status definitions.

upgrade - A move to a higher service category, room type, or product capability.

service recovery - Actions taken to address a service failure and restore the customer's experience.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Improve this sentence: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry you did not read it correctly.
 - B. I'm sorry if you chose to misunderstand it.
 - C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
 - B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

SITUATION

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

guest complaint - A guest's expression of dissatisfaction with a hospitality service.

online review - Public feedback posted on a digital platform about a product or experience.

brand voice - The recognizable style and tone a brand uses in communication.

compensation - Payment or another remedy; in employment, the pay and benefits provided for work.

3. Notice the language

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

In [specific situation], I noticed ...

The effect was ... What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Improve this sentence: You are always careless.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give feedback people can use

4. Check the language

1. Which feedback begins with observable behavior?
 - A. You are the kind of person who ignores details.
 - B. The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.
 - C. You obviously do not care about our work.
2. Which follow-up invites useful information before agreeing on support?
 - A. What is making this part of the task difficult?
 - B. There cannot be any reasonable explanation.
 - C. You should already know what I am thinking.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

overbooking - Accepting more reservations than the available capacity based on expected cancellations or no-shows.

walk - In hospitality, relocating a guest to another property when the booked accommodation cannot be supplied.

occupancy - The proportion of available rooms occupied or sold during a stated period.

rate parity - An arrangement concerning consistency of hotel rates across specified distribution channels.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Improve this sentence: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope will change, we review yesterday's schedule.
 - C. If the scope changed tomorrow, we reviewed the schedule yesterday.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - B. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - C. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

ADR - Average daily rate: room revenue divided by rooms sold for the stated period.

RevPAR - Revenue per available room: room revenue divided by available rooms for the stated period.

yield management - Adjusting price and availability to manage revenue from limited, time-sensitive capacity.

compression night - A hotel-market period of strong demand and limited room availability.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Improve this sentence: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is an important operational backlog.
 - B. The backlog must be reviewed at the backlog meeting.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. You understand everything now, don't you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. I have explained the next step, so shall we finish?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

room status - A room's recorded availability or service condition, such as occupied or out of order.

out of order - A room or item unavailable for normal use because of a problem or required work.

turnover - Preparing a room for the next guest; in staffing, the rate of people leaving an organization.

preventive maintenance - Planned work intended to reduce failures and maintain equipment condition.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Improve this sentence: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
 - B. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - C. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?
 - B. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - C. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

BEO - Banquet event order: a document specifying arrangements and responsibilities for an event.

run of show - A timed sequence of an event's activities and responsibilities.

attrition - An agreed reduction in booked event rooms or attendance, sometimes subject to charges.

AV requirement - An audio or visual equipment need for an event, such as microphones or projection.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

itinerary - A planned sequence of travel activities, locations, and times.

force majeure - A contractual provision addressing specified events beyond a party's control; effects depend on the wording and law.

waiver - A documented relinquishment or exception concerning a right or requirement, subject to applicable terms and law.

local operator - A provider responsible for delivering travel or tour services in a destination.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In every location, the result will be ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

service standard - A stated expectation for how a service should be delivered.

cultural expectation - An expectation shaped by experience and social context; it should not be assumed from nationality alone.

guest profile - Relevant recorded preferences and service information about a guest, handled under applicable privacy rules.

recovery gesture - An authorized service action intended to help address a disappointing guest experience.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response, not a script to memorize. Your written version needs a subject line, an opening, and appropriate context. Assess it using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This shifts blame to the reader.

B: This attributes an unverified motive to the listener.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Editing example: The last two reports omitted the agreed summary section.

The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Check 1: B - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.

A: This labels a person rather than an action.

B: The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.

C: This assumes motivation rather than describing behavior.

Check 2: A - What is making this part of the task difficult?

A: An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

B: This closes off relevant information.

C: This relies on unstated expectations.

Model response: Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the if-clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The if-clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

B: The tense pattern and time reference do not express the intended future condition.

C: The conflicting time references make the condition unclear.

Check 2: C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

B: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

C: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

Model response: The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Revenue Management and Pricing

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Repeating the same term does not define it.

B: This describes a meeting but leaves the term unexplained.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This leading question makes it easy to agree without showing understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Finishing the conversation gives no evidence of understanding.

Model response: The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

B: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

C: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

Check 2: A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

B: It changes pending information into a final result.

C: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

Model response: Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

Model response: The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.